Experiment-12

Implementing Security Features and Governance/Administration Practices in Zoho Creator

Aim:

To implement and explore security features and governance practices in Zoho Creator to protect application data, control user access, maintain data integrity, and ensure secure and efficient application management.

Theory:

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform that provides security and administration features to manage applications and protect sensitive information.

Security ensures that only authorized users can access specific application data and perform permitted operations. Governance refers to the policies, rules, and practices used to manage application development, access, data protection, and maintenance.

The major security and governance features in Zoho Creator include:

1. **User Authentication:** Ensures that users sign in using authorized accounts before accessing the application.
2. **Role-Based Access Control:** Assigns roles and permissions to users based on their responsibilities.
3. **Permission Management:** Controls whether users can view, add, edit, or delete records.
4. **Data Validation:** Ensures that submitted data meets specified conditions and reduces invalid entries.
5. **Field-Level Security:** Restricts access to sensitive fields where supported by the application's configuration.
6. **Audit and Activity Monitoring:** Helps administrators review relevant user activities and changes where audit features are available.
7. **Application Administration:** Allows authorized administrators to manage users, permissions, application settings, and maintenance.
8. **Data Backup and Recovery:** Helps protect application information against accidental loss and supports recovery where the relevant features are configured.

For example, in a Library Book Issue Management System, an administrator may manage all book issue records, while

library staff may be permitted to add and update records. Students may be given access only to their permitted information. These restrictions help prevent unauthorized modifications and protect library data.

Procedure:

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the Library Book Issue application.
2. Open the application settings and examine the available security and user-management options.
3. Identify the available roles and permissions for application users.
4. Configure appropriate user access permissions based on responsibilities, where supported.
5. Set report and form permissions to control who can view, add, edit, or delete records.
6. Configure mandatory fields and validation rules to prevent incomplete or invalid data entry.
7. Review field-level access settings and restrict sensitive information where required.
8. Examine available audit logs or activity-monitoring features to understand how application activities can be reviewed.
9. Review administration settings for user management, application configuration, and data protection.
10. Test the configured permissions using authorized test accounts or the available testing method.
11. Verify that users can perform only the operations permitted by their assigned access rights.

Result:

Thus, the security features and governance/administration practices of Zoho Creator were studied and configured where available. The experiment demonstrated how user authentication, access permissions, data validation, activity monitoring, and administration practices help protect application data and improve the secure management of a low-code application.